

A1 and the End Time 9:50 AM in cell A2. If we simply subtract the Start Time from the End Time (as in “=A2-A1”) we get “#####”, as Excel cannot work with negative times. So we can workaroud this in two ways, as below:

m =MAX(A1,A2)-MIN(A1:A2)

m =A1-A2+IF(A1>A2,1)

We can also easily tell Excel to add to any date any amount of days, months or years. Here's how:

=DATE(YEAR(A1)+value1,MONTH(A1)+value2,DAY(A1)+value3)

So to add one month to a date in cell A1 we could use:

=DATE(YEAR(A1),MONTH(A1)+1,DAY(A1))

There are, however, some other Date and Time functions Excel has that are part of the 'Analysis ToolPak'. Click 'Add-Ins' on the 'Tools' menu. Click to select the 'Analysis ToolPak' check box, and then click 'Yes' if you are asked whether you want to install it.

You will then have functions such as EDATE, EOMONTH, NETWORKDAYS, WEEKNUM, and more. All these will be found under the 'Date & Time' category of the 'Paste' function dialog, 'Function Wizard'. These are very easy to use and the 'Help' in Excel explains these well.

All too often, spreadsheets that have data imported (or just entered incorrectly) end up with dates and times being seen as text and not real numbers. You can easily spot this in Excel by widening the columns a bit then selecting the column and clicking on **Format > Cells > Alignment** and changing the Horizontal alignment to 'General', the cell's default. Then click 'OK', and look at your dates and times, any that are *not* right-aligned are not true date and/or times. Here's how to fix this: